

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

-----X
MILLIE BLIGEN,

Plaintiff,

- against -

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GARCIA and
P.O. GAMWELSH,

Defendants.
-----X

Index No.

Plaintiff designates
New York County as
place of trial.

The basis of the
venue is the
location of occurrence.

S U M M O N S

Plaintiff resides at
320 West 111th St. (#17)
New York, N.Y. 10026

County of New York

To the above named defendant(s):

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgement will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: New York, New York
September 22, 2014

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
MILLIE BLIGEN
Office & P.O. Address
11 Park Place, 10th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 227-8865

The City of New York, 100 Church Street, New York, NY 10007
P.O. Garcia, c/o 28th Pct., 2271 Eighth Avenue, New York, NY 10027
P.O. Gamwelsh, c/o 28th Pct., 2271 Eighth Avenue, New York, NY 10027

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

-----X
MILLIE BLIGEN,

Index No.

Plaintiff,

- against -

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GARCIA and
P.O. GAMWELSH,

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff, complaining of the defendants, by her attorneys, SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C., hereby sets forth and alleges, upon information and belief, as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on March 19, 2014, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was and still is a resident of the County of New York, City and State of New York.

2. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on March 19, 2014, the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, (hereinafter referred to as "**THE CITY**") was and still is a domestic municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

3. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on March 19, 2014, defendant, **P.O. GARCIA**, (hereinafter referred to as "**GARCIA**"), was and still is a resident of the City and State of New York.

4. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on March 19, 2014, defendant, **P.O. GAMWELSH**, (hereinafter referred to as "**GAMWELSH**"), was and still is a resident of the City and State of New York.

5. That, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, has complied with all the conditions precedent to the commencement of the within action against the defendant, **THE CITY**; plaintiff's Notice of Claim was served on May 22, 2014, within ninety (90) days of the date that the within cause of action having been caused to accrue; that thirty (30) days have elapsed and the claim remains unpaid and unadjusted; that, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, testified at an oral examination pursuant to the General Municipal Law on July 22, 2014; and, that this action is being commenced herewith within one (1) year and ninety (90) days of the date that the within cause of action having been caused to accrue.

6. That, on March 19, 2014, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** was in front of premises known as 320 West 111th Street in the County of New York, City and State of New York.

7. That, on March 19, 2014, various police officers were in the general vicinity of 320 West 111th Street in the County of New York, City and State of New York.

8. That the plaintiff's son was present with the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, at the aforementioned location wherein the police officers were also present.

9. That the plaintiff's son wanted to gain access into

the plaintiff's apartment and voiced this request to the police officers.

10. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, asked that the police officers provide medical assistance and treatment for her son who needed to be seen in the hospital due to mental issues.

11. Thereafter, other defendants, agents and/or employees and/or police officers of the defendant, **THE CITY**, came to the scene of the above occurrence, which included, but was not limited to defendant **GAMWELSH** and defendant **GARCIA**.

12. That the defendant and/or defendants had told the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, that the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN'S** son had to be let into the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's**, apartment.

13. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, explained to the police officers, agents, servants and/or employees of the defendant and/or defendants that the plaintiff's son did not reside with the plaintiff at the plaintiff's aforementioned apartment.

14. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was threatened by the defendant and/or defendants that she would be arrested if she did not allow her son to gain access into plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's**, apartment.

15. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was thereafter arrested by the defendant and/or defendants, was cursed at by the defendant and/or defendants with foul language and thereafter taken to the 28th Precinct wherein the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was in pain in the areas of her arm and her back.

16. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was thereafter taken to Central Booking and the Assistant District Attorney had required that the police officers remove the handcuffs from the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, had apologized to the plaintiff and had offered assistance to get help for the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**.

17. That all charges were dropped, declined, and/or disposed of in favor of the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, in that the District Attorney, refused and/or declined to prosecute the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

18. That, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 17 with the same force and effect as if hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

19. That, on March 19, 2014, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was assaulted/battered by the defendant, and/or defendants by and through their agents, servants and/or employees.

20. That, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was assaulted/battered without justification and without cause and without excuse.

21. That, the assault/battery took place in front of premises known as 320 West 111th Street, in the County of New York, City and State of New York, and other locations wherein the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** was held against her will by the defendant and/or defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees.

22. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned and on March 19, 2014, and for sometime prior thereto, defendant, **GARCIA**, was a New York City police officer, and/or agent servant and/or employee of the defendant, **THE CITY**, working in the scope and course of her employment as a New York City Police Officer, and was employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

23. That, at all times hereinafter mentioned and on March 19, 2014, and for sometime prior thereto, defendant, **GAMWELSH**, was a New York City police officer, and/or agent servant and/or employee of the defendant, **THE CITY**, working in the scope and course of her employment as a New York City Police Officer, and was employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

24. That, the aforementioned assault and battery of the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was carried out by police officers and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, and/or defendants, while working within the scope and course of the employment with the defendants, **THE CITY**.

25. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was caused to undergo hospital and medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue her usual and regular activities; and, upon information and belief, her injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

26. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional

actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

27. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

28. That, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 27 with the same force and effect as if hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

29. That, all of the aforementioned acts, committed by police officers, servants, and/or other employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**, were committed due to the negligence, recklessness and carelessness of the aforementioned police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

30. That the defendant, **THE CITY**, was additionally negligent, reckless and careless in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of various police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees, who were employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

31. That, all of the aforementioned acts, committed by the police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees of the defendant, **GARCIA**, were committed due to the negligence,

recklessness and carelessness of the aforementioned police officers, agents, servants and/or employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

32. That, all of the aforementioned acts, committed by the police officers, agents, servants and/or other employees of the defendant, **GAMWELSH**, were committed due to the negligence, recklessness and carelessness of the aforementioned police officers, agents, servants and/or employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

33. That, the defendant, **THE CITY**, was additionally negligent, reckless and careless in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of various police officers, agents, servants, and/or other employees, including, but not limited to defendant, **GARCIA**, who was employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

34. That, the defendant, **THE CITY**, was additionally negligent, reckless and careless in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of various police officers, agents, servants, and/or other employees, including, but not limited to defendant, **GAMWELSH**, who was employed by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

35. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was caused to undergo hospital and medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue her usual and regular activities; and, upon information and belief, her injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

36. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving the defendant and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

37. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

38. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 37 with the same force and effect as if hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

39. That, on March 19, 2014, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was caused to be falsely arrested and falsely imprisoned without probable cause.

40. That, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was arrested without an arrest warrant.

41. That, the false arrest/false imprisonment took place in front of premises known as 320 West 111th Street, in the County of New York, City and State of New York, and other locations and wherein the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** was held against her will by the defendant and/or defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees.

42. That, the aforementioned false arrest and false

imprisonment of the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was carried out by police officers and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

43. That, the aforementioned false arrest and false imprisonment of the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was carried out by defendant, **GARCIA**, and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**, while working within the scope and course of the employment with the defendant, **THE CITY**.

44. That, the aforementioned false arrest and false imprisonment of the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was carried out by defendant, **GAMWELSH**, and/or other servants, agents and/or employees of the defendant, **THE CITY**, while working within the scope and course of the employment with the defendant, **THE CITY**.

45. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was caused to undergo hospital medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue her usual and regular activities; and, upon information and belief, her injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

46. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions as well as the defendant and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

47. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff,

MILLIE BLIGEN, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

48. The plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, repeats, reiterates, and realleges, each and every allegation as set forth in paragraphs 1 through 47, with the same force and effect as if hereinafter more fully set forth at length herein.

49. That the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** did not commit any illegal act, nor did the individually named defendant have reason to believe she committed an unlawful act, either before or at the time she was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted and battered, excessive force was used against her; and deprived her of her constitutional rights pursuant to the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments as set forth in the Constitution of the United States, particularly 42 U.S.C. §1983 and the Constitution of the State of New York.

50. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, **GARCIA**, was employed in her respective capacity by the defendant, **THE CITY** and was acting under the color of her official capacity and her acts were performed under the color of the policies, statutes, ordinances, rules and regulations of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

51. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, **GAMWELSH**, was employed in her respective capacity by the defendant, **THE CITY** and was acting under the color of her official

capacity and his acts were performed under the color of the policies, statutes, ordinances, rules and regulations of the defendant, **THE CITY**.

52. Defendant, **GARCIA**, is being sued in her personal and official capacities for violation of plaintiff's constitutional rights pursuant to 42 USC, §1983. Although defendants knew or should have known of the fact that this pattern of conduct was carried out by their agents, servants and/or employees, the defendant, **THE CITY** has not taken any steps or made any efforts to halt this course of conduct, to make redress to the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, or other citizens injured thereby, or to take any disciplinary action whatever against any of their employees or agents.

53. Defendant, **GAMWELSH**, is being sued in her personal and official capacities for violation of plaintiff's constitutional rights pursuant to 42 USC, §1983. Although defendants knew or should have known of the fact that this pattern of conduct was carried out by their agents, servants and/or employees, the defendant, **THE CITY** has not taken any steps or made any efforts to halt this course of conduct, to make redress to the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, or other citizens injured thereby, or to take any disciplinary action whatever against any of their employees or agents.

54. The unlawful and illegal conduct of the defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees and each of them, deprived plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** of the following rights, privileges and

immunities secured to her by the Constitution of the United States and of the State of New York: The right of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** to be secure in her person and effects against unreasonable search and seizure under the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States; the right of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, to be informed of the nature and cause of the accusation against her as secured to her under the Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States; and the right of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, not to be deprived of life, liberty or property without due process of law, and the right to the equal protection of the laws secured by the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

55. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the unconstitutional acts of defendant, **GARCIA**, while acting under color of state law and within the scope of her employ.

56. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the unconstitutional acts of defendant, **GAMWELSH**, while acting under color of state law and within the scope of her employ.

57. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the defendant, **THE CITY's** custom and/or policy of arresting individuals without probable cause.

58. That the deprivation of plaintiff's Constitutional rights was the result of the defendant, **THE CITY's** custom and/or

policy of arresting minorities without probable cause.

59. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** Constitutional Rights was the result of the defendant, **THE CITY's** custom and/or policy of failing to discipline officers for arresting individuals without probable cause.

60. That the said customs and/or policies may be inferred from the existence of other similar Civil Rights actions that have been brought against the defendant, **THE CITY**.

61. That the detaining of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** without probable cause or justification was the result of customs and/or policies adopted by the defendant, **THE CITY**.

62. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's** Constitutional Rights was the result of the defendant, **GARCIA's** arrest of the plaintiff **MILLIE BLIGEN** without probable cause.

63. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's** Constitutional Rights was the result of the defendant, **GAMWELSH's** arrest of the plaintiff **MILLIE BLIGEN** without probable cause.

64. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's** Constitutional Rights was a result of the defendant, **THE CITY's** custom and policy in failing to discipline officers for the use of excessive force.

65. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's** Constitutional Rights was the result of **GARCIA's** use of excessive force.

66. That the deprivation of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN's** Constitutional Rights was the result of **GAMWELSH's** use of excessive force.

67. That the customs and/or policies adopted by the defendant, **THE CITY** exhibited a deliberate indifference to the Constitutional rights of plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN.**

68. That by reason of the allegations as set forth in all of the aforementioned causes of actions, including, but not limited to the plaintiff's false arrest, false imprisonment, assault and battery, the negligence of the defendant and/or defendants, in the negligent hiring, negligent retention, and negligent training of its various employees and/or police officers, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN** was caused to have her civil rights as guaranteed under the U.S. Constitution, including, but not limited to the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments, violated by the defendant and/or defendants herein, as set forth under 42 U.S.C. Section 1983.

69. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff **MILLIE BLIGEN** was injured; was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled; was caused to undergo hospital and medical treatment and advice; was unable to pursue her usual and regular activities; and upon information and belief, her injuries are permanent in nature and effect.

70. That this action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving the defendant and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for

the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

71. That, by reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff, **MILLIE BLIGEN**, demands judgment against the defendants, on the First, Second, Third, and Fourth causes of action in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all of the lower Courts of the State of New York; together with interest, as well as the costs, disbursements and legal fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. Section 1988, of these causes of action.

Dated: New York, New York
September 22, 2014

Yours, etc.

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.
Attorneys for Plaintiff,
MILLIE BLIGEN
Office & P.O. Address
11 Park Place, 10th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 227-8865

INDIVIDUAL VERIFICATION

STATE OF NEW YORK)
) .SS:
COUNTY OF NEW YORK)

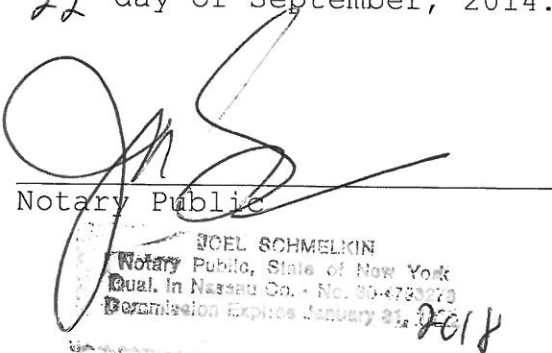
MILLIE BLIGEN, being duly sworn deposes and says:

I am the plaintiff in this action. I have read the foregoing COMPLAINT and know its contents and the same are true to my knowledge and belief except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters I believe it to be true.



MILLIE BLIGEN

Sworn to before me this
22 day of September, 2014.



Notary Public

JOEL SCHMALKIN
Notary Public, State of New York
Qual. in Nassau Co. - No. 80-473073
Commission Expires January 31, 2018

Index No.

Year 20

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

MILLIE BLIGEN,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, P.O. GARCIA and
P.O. GAMWELSH,

Defendants.

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.

Attorneys for Plaintiff(s) Millie Bligen

Office and Post Office Address, Telephone

11 PARK PLACE, 10TH FLOOR

NEW YORK, N.Y. 10007

TEL: (212) 227-8865

Pursuant to 22 NYCRR 130-1.1-a, the undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, certifies that, upon information and belief and reasonable inquiry, (1) the contentions contained in the annexed document are not frivolous and that (2) if the annexed document is an initiating pleading, (i) the matter was not obtained through illegal conduct, or that if it was, the attorney or other persons responsible for the illegal conduct are not participating in the matter or sharing in any fee earned therefrom and that (ii) if the matter involves potential claims for personal injury or wrongful death, the matter was not obtained in violation of 22 NYCRR 1200.41-a.

Dated: September 22, 2014...

Signature

Print Signer's Name..... JOEL SCHMELKIN, ESQ.

Service of a copy of the within

is hereby admitted.

Dated:

Attorney(s) for

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE

Check Applicable Box

☐

NOTICE OF
ENTRY

that the within is a (certified) true copy of a
entered in the office of the clerk of the within-named Court on

20

☐

NOTICE OF
SETTLEMENT

that an Order of which the within is a true copy will be presented for settlement to the
Hon. , one of the judges of the within-named Court,
at
on

20

, at

M.

Dated:

SCHMELKIN ASSOCIATES, P.C.

Attorneys for Plaintiff(s)

To:

Office and Post Office Address, Telephone

11 PARK PLACE, 10TH FLOOR

NEW YORK, N.Y. 10007